

DELHI | Captain's Move

Vendetta politics in Punjab took a new turn as former chief minister Amarinder Singh rushed to Delhi and held a press conference against his political rivals, Akali Chief Minister of Punjab Parkash Singh Badal and his son Sukhbir Singh Badal. "A different type of terrorism is spreading in the state. After Sukhbir was given the home portfolio, he is using his power blatantly to spread terror," alleged Amarinder. He was flanked by Union Minister Ambika Soni and Congress spokesman Maneesh Tewari. The delegation wants Punjab to be declared a "sensitive" state and central forces to be deputed in Punjab during elections. "We want free and fair elections. Without the Centre's help it will be a free



AMARINDER (CENTRE) HAS HIT OUT AGAINST CHIEF MINISTER BADAL

for all," Amarinder said. Added Soni, "It is shoraj in the state." Amarinder is facing corruption charges, which he claims are another form of the Badals' vendetta.

by Priya Sahgal

Bill Kill

Though there are over 40 Bills awaiting parliamentary approval, the next session is expected to be dominated by the Election Commission controversy. Apart from the Vote on Account, the Government is not hopeful of getting much work done this time.

YASBANT NEGI



MULAYAM

NEW DELHI | Hard Court

The CBI has landed in trouble with the Supreme Court (sc) over its handling of the disproportionate assets case against Mulayam Singh Yadav. The CBI seems to have been flip-flopping over whom to hand over its report into Mulayam's affairs—the Government or the apex court. After Mulayam supported the UPA Government on the Indo-US nuke deal, the CBI has allegedly taken a "soft" stand on him, with, his opponents say, higher political blessings. After the CBI's dithering, the sc has reserved its order on whether a regular FIR can be lodged against Yadav. Yadav, sons Akhilesh and Prateek and daughter-in-law Dimple are being investigated in the case. by Shyam Lal Yadav

BANGALORE |

Lest We Forget

As part of a push to recognise the men in uniform, Karnataka Governor Rameshwar Thakur laid the foundation for the first major post-Independence military memorial. The memorial is the brainchild of independent MP Rajeev Chandra-

PTI

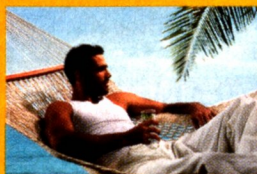


sekhar, who wants other states to erect similar memorials to honour the armed forces. Karnataka's memorial will be a two-storey high egg-shaped granite 'warrior's stone'.

by Stephen David



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Blank Slate

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